

Vodafone (VOD.L): Modest 1Q27 beat and Africa-driven raise likely to reassure while limited Europe growth continues

Vodafone's 1Q27 results brought a modest beat, with Group underlying guidance upgraded to reflect an improved outlook in Africa. We would expect the shares to be up modestly today reflecting: 1) a Europe-driven beat in the quarter but which is mainly due to easier comps and lumpy revenues in Germany; 2) Group guidance driven by Africa which is only partly driven by structural factors. Company commentary on fundamental growth drivers across the Group is broadly unchanged. With Vodafone now guiding Group EBITDA and Adj FCF guidance to the upper end of its previous range, this implies around 7% and 20% yoy growth respectively for FY27, though we note that the Europe-based growth remains unchanged and limited.

Key investor focus likely to be on: 1) African growth better, drives Group guidance uplift - we note Vodacom (Vodafone's listed main African business) raised guidance in its results today. This reflects a better than expected macro backdrop and favourable energy hedging as well as the more structural positive that recent price rises have landed well across the region; **2) Europe organic service revenue growth (OSRG) remains stable** at +0.9% (vs +0.8% 4Q26); **3) Germany growth sustained but set to deteriorate through the year** - OSRG was +1.2% yoy 1Q27 (vs +1.3% 4Q26), +1ppt vs consensus given the growing drag of lost 1&1 wholesale contract revenues was improved by better broadband ARPU growth and B2B digital services growth. Through FY27 VOD continues to guide for an increasing headwind from lost 1&1 revenues (particularly in Q2), and notes that Digital Services revenue is lumpy and was particularly strong in 2Q26 - we note consensus models OSRG -1.1% yoy 2Q27; **4) UK underlying trends broadly unchanged** - OSRG was +0.6% yoy 1Q27 (vs -0.2% 4Q26 but this was due to easy comps from vs 1Q26 when there was a material fall in managed services revenues. Overall, VOD notes the underlying growth backdrop in the UK is unchanged and still sees VOD/3 synergies delivery is on track.

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In the detail

■ Germany

- The company reported +1.2% OSRG growth. This compares to +1.3%/+0.7%/+0.5%/-0.3% growth in 4Q26/3Q26/2Q26/1Q26 excluding the impact of TV billing headwinds, and +1.3%/+0.7%/+0.5%/-3.2% in 4Q26/3Q26/2Q26/1Q26 including.
- Broadband net adds for this quarter declined -98k (vs.

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-90k/-63k/-26k/-23k in 4Q26/3Q26/2Q26/1Q26).

- Vodafone Germany reported -85k postpaid net adds in 1Q27 (vs. -77k/+11k/-1k/-36k in 4Q26/3Q26/2Q26/1Q26).

■ UK

- Vodafone lost -48k postpaid subscribers in the quarter (vs. -22k/-73k/+14k/-46k in 4Q26/3Q26/2Q26/1Q26).
- 1Q27 broadband net adds were +34k (vs. +64k/+64k/+50k/+44k in 4Q26/3Q26/2Q26/1Q26).

- **FY27 guidance updated:** Please see the exhibit below for details.

Exhibit 1: The company has reiterated FY27 guidance

Guidance vs. company-compiled consensus

FY27E	Previous guidance*	Updated guidance*	Consensus	Guidance vs. consensus
	(€bn)	(€bn)	(€mn)	
Europe EBITDAaL	€7.6 – 7.9bn	€7.6 – 7.9bn	7,798	-0.6%
Group adj. EBITDAaL	€13.0bn-13.3bn	Upper end of: €13.0bn-13.3bn	13,115	0.8%
Group adj. free cash flow	€2.6bn-2.9bn	Upper end of: €2.6bn-2.9bn	2,780	1.6%

Note: FY27 guidance 1) includes Safaricom, and 2) reflects the following FX rates: €1: GBP 0.85; €1: ZAR 20.59; €1: TRY 43.42; €1: EGP 56.74.

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: 1Q27 Results vs. Visible Alpha Consensus Data

Vodafone, 1Q27	Actual	Visible Alpha consensus	Actual vs. Consensus
Organic Service Revenue Growth (%)			
Germany	1.2%	0.1%	1.1pp
UK	0.6%	0.5%	0.1pp
Other Europe	1.0%	1.1%	-0.1pp
Europe OSRG	0.9%	0.4%	0.5pp
Vodacom	12.6%	11.5%	1.1pp
Group OSRG	5.2%	5.0%	0.2pp
Service revenues (€mn)			
Germany	2,740	2,696	1.6%
UK	1,988	1,974	0.7%
Other Europe & eliminations	1,216	1,192	2.0%
Europe service revenues	5,944	5,862	1.4%
Vodacom	1,790	1,816	-1.4%
Other	892	849	5.1%
Group service revenues	8,626	8,526	1.2%
Total revenues (€mn)			
Europe revenues	6,813	6,694	1.8%
Other incl. Vodacom	3,481	3,628	-4.1%
Group revenues	10,294	10,322	-0.3%

Source: Visible Alpha Consensus Data, Company data

Exhibit 3: Organic service revenue growth trends

Organic growth	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27
Germany service revenues	-1.5%	-6.2%	-6.4%	-6.0%	-3.2%	0.5%	0.7%	1.3%	1.2%
Germany service revenues excl. TV headwinds	-0.3%	-2.4%	-2.6%	-3.0%	-0.3%	0.5%	0.7%	1.3%	1.2%
UK service revenues	0.0%	1.2%	3.3%	3.1%	0.9%	1.2%	-0.5%	-0.2%	0.6%
Other Europe service revenues	2.3%	2.6%	2.6%	0.8%	0.2%	-0.5%	1.2%	1.2%	1.0%
Europe service revenues	-0.3%	-2.3%	-1.9%	-2.1%	-1.3%	0.5%	0.5%	0.8%	0.9%
Africa service revenues	10.0%	9.7%	11.6%	13.5%	13.8%	13.5%	13.5%	10.9%	12.6%
Turkey (prev. other markets) service revenues	91.9%	89.1%	83.4%	73.2%	63.8%	48.4%	38.5%	33.7%	30.2%
Group service revenues	5.4%	4.2%	5.2%	5.4%	5.5%	5.8%	5.4%	5.1%	5.2%

Source: Company data

Valuation and risks

We are Sell rated on Vodafone. Our 12-month price target is 85p (\$11.58 for the ADR) and is based on our EV/IC to ROIC/WACC methodology.

Key upside risks to our thesis and price target include: 1) 1&1 network rollout halt, independent of consolidation; 2) Vodafone participating in German consolidation; 3)

Greater market repair benefits than expected in the UK; 4) Stronger execution than expected; 5) Better competitive environment across key markets than expected; and 5) Emerging Markets upside risk

VOD.L	12m Price Target: 85p	Price: 114.6p	Downside: 25.8%
VOD	12m Price Target: \$11.58	Price: \$15.15	Downside: 23.6%

Sell		GS Forecast			
Market cap: £31.0bn / \$41.3bn Enterprise value: £71.1bn / \$94.8bn 3m ADTV: £93.3mn / \$125.2mn United Kingdom Europe Telecoms M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	Revenue (€ mn)	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
	EBIT (€ mn)	40,461.0	41,922.1	42,386.8	42,939.1
	EPS (€)	3,226.0	4,013.6	4,548.5	5,196.1
	EPS (€)	(0.01)	0.07	0.09	0.11
	P/E (X)	NM	19.0	15.3	12.4
	EV/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	5.6	5.9	5.6	5.3
	Dividend yield (%)	4.5	3.5	3.6	3.7
	FCF yield (%)	8.4	7.2	7.8	8.7
	CROCI (%)	13.1	14.2	14.6	15.0
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	2.9	2.7	2.5	2.2
		9/25	3/26	9/26E	3/27E
	EPS (€)	0.03	(0.05)	0.05	0.02

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 24 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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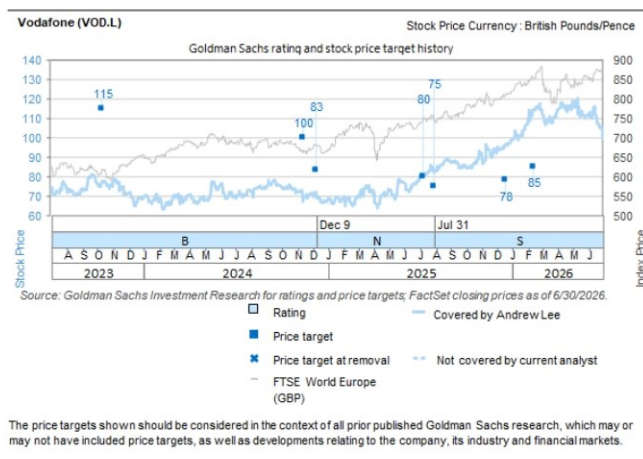
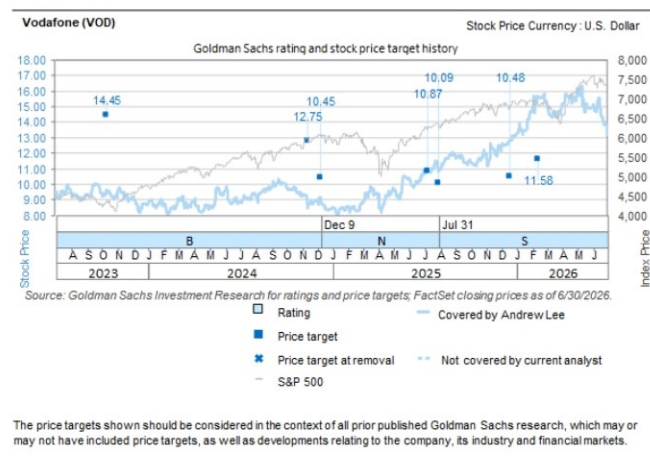
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

Vodafone (VOD.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
13-Feb-26	85	114.15
19-Dec-25	78	96.58
31-Jul-25	75	82.02
08-Jul-25	80	80.46
09-Dec-24	83	70.82
13-Nov-24	100	69.06
11-Oct-23	115	77.51

Vodafone (VOD)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
13-Feb-26	11.58	15.57
19-Dec-25	10.48	12.84
31-Jul-25	10.09	10.81
08-Jul-25	10.87	10.87
09-Dec-24	10.45	8.92
13-Nov-24	12.75	8.75
11-Oct-23	14.45	9.68

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